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A COMPOSITIONAL AND DIAGRAMMATIC SYNTAX FOR PARAMETRIC
LINEAR PROGRAMMING

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Dissertação de Mestrado apresentada ao Programa de Pós-Graduação em Informática, Instituto de Computação e Instituto Tércio Pacitti de Aplicações e Pesquisas Computacionais, Universidade Federal do Rio de Janeiro, como requisito parcial à obtenção do título de Mestre em Informática.

Orientador: Prof. João Paixão, D.Sc.

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RESUMO

Esta dissertação investiga como problemas de otimização podem ser compreendidos dentro de um arcabouço composicional e diagramático unificado, fundamentado na teoria das categorias. A motivação central é a observação de que estruturas matemáticas essenciais em otimização — relações, funções convexas, formas quadráticas, poliedros e programas lineares — podem ser interpretadas como morfismos em categorias nas quais a composição corresponde à eliminação ou minimização de variáveis internas. A partir desta perspectiva, a otimização emerge não como uma coleção de técnicas isoladas, mas como uma operação algébrica inerente à estrutura relacional. O desenvolvimento segue uma progressão incremental, partindo das relações binárias clássicas enriquecidas por quantais de Lawvere. A cada etapa é introduzido um único gerador novo e um conjunto finito de axiomas. A Álgebra Quadrática Gráfica (GQA) representa problemas de minimização da norma ℓ_2 sobre subespaços afins; a Álgebra Poliedral enriquece o arcabouço com restrições de desigualdade linear; e a Álgebra Gráfica para Programação Linear Paramétrica (GLP) constitui a contribuição central da tese, na qual um programa linear é tratado como um morfismo compositável com outros blocos de otimização. Para cada álgebra são demonstrados resultados de solidez e completude com respeito às categorias semânticas correspondentes. Um resultado central mostra que toda função convexa afim por partes admite representação como função valor de um programa linear, e que essa equivalência se manifesta diagramaticamente como uma forma normal canônica, eliminando no nível sintático a distinção entre um LP e uma função convexa. O cálculo diagramático para GLP desempenha, para a programação linear, o mesmo papel que a Álgebra Linear Gráfica desempenha para matrizes: fornece uma linguagem de formas normais, regras de reescrita e teoremas de completude dentro dos quais argumentos de otimização podem ser conduzidos simbolicamente, antes e independentemente de qualquer computação numérica.

Palavras-chave: teoria das categorias; diagramas de corda; programação linear; otimização convexa; categorias monoidais simétricas; relações ponderadas; quantais; álgebra gráfica; formas normais; completude.

ABSTRACT

This dissertation investigates how optimization problems can be understood within a unified compositional and diagrammatic framework grounded in category theory. The central observation is that key mathematical structures in optimization can be interpreted as morphisms in categories whose composition corresponds to the elimination or minimization of internal variables. From this perspective, optimization emerges not as a collection of isolated techniques but as an algebraic operation intrinsic to relational structure.

The development follows an incremental progression rooted in Lawvere quantales and weighted relations, adding one new generator and a finite set of axioms at each step. We recall the theory of Quantale relations and the Polyhedral Algebra framework as preliminaries steps to develop the novel Graphical Linear Programming (GLP), where morphisms – diagrams – are parametric linear programs. Those composes with other optimization blocks, so that the elimination of internal variables, or, in this case, the optimization itself, corresponds exactly to categorical composition. Soundness and completeness results for the previous algebras are recalled from prior works, and in the last section we also present the completeness theorem for our new language.

The diagrammatic calculus plays the same role for linear programming that Graphical Linear Algebra plays for matrices: it provides a expressible language for normal forms and rewriting rules in which arguments can be carried out symbolically, prior to and independently of numerical computation, making the main properties of the system evident in the syntax itself. The tools and results developed and proved here are this diagrammatic calculus for Linear Programming.

Keywords: category theory; string diagrams; linear programming; convex optimization; symmetric monoidal categories; weighted relations; quantales; graphical algebra; normal forms; completeness.

SUMÁRIO

1	POLYHEDRAL RELATIONS	1
1.1	SEMANTICS: THE PROP PCREL OF POLYHEDRAL CONES.....	1
1.2	SYNTAX: THE ALGEBRA GPA _⊥	2
1.3	THE ORDER STRUCTURE OF THE INEQUALITY GENERATOR.....	3
1.4	FOURIER–MOTZKIN ELIMINATION	7
1.5	PRESENTATION RESULTS FOR PCREL	11
1.6	SEMANTICS: THE PROP POLYREL OF POLYHEDRA.....	15
1.7	SYNTAX: THE ALGEBRA GPA	16
1.8	PRESENTATION RESULTS FOR POLYREL	17
2	THE LINEAR PROGRAMMING CATEGORY.....	20
2.1	SEMANTICS: THE PROP LPREL	20
2.2	SYNTAX: THE ALGEBRA GLP	22
2.3	PRESENTATION RESULTS FOR LPREL	29
A	RULES OF THE UNDERLYING ALGEBRAS.....	33

1 POLYHEDRAL RELATIONS

We now turn to a combinatorially richer class of objects: polyhedra and polyhedral cones. These are the fundamental geometric structures underlying linear programming, and they admit a categorical treatment entirely analogous to the one developed for linear and affine relations. The key difference is that composition here is governed by Fourier-Motzkin Elimination (FME): projecting a polyhedron onto a subspace is precisely variable elimination, and it is this operation that categorical composition will simulate diagrammatically.

The theory developed here remains within the category of binary relations, since morphisms are still indicator functions of subsets of $\mathbb{R}^n \times \mathbb{R}^m$, encoding feasibility constraints rather than objective functions. In this sense, **GPA** does not yet enter the weighted relational world, and so is not yet able to express more meaningful optimization problems. This is nonetheless a critical step in the development. Axiomatizing linear inequality constraints diagrammatically, **GPA** provides the Symmetric Monoidal Inequality Theory (SMIT) [BDS21] that will serve as the structural foundation for our final contribution, **GLP**, where these constraints are combined with a linear objective to form full parametric linear programs.

In what follows we describe and show the complete theory of polyhedral relations and polyhedral cones. Just as **AffRel** captured affine space as morphisms, the categories **PCRel** and **PolyRel** capture polyhedral cones and polyhedra as morphisms, with relational composition playing the role of variable elimination.

1.1 SEMANTICS: THE PROP **PCREL** OF POLYHEDRAL CONES

We begin by recalling the standard definitions of polyhedral cones and the corresponding semantic category.

Definition 1.1. *A set $C \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ is called a polyhedral cone if there exists a matrix $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$ such that*

$$C = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid Ax \geq 0\}.$$

Definition 1.2 (The prop **PCRel** of polyhedral cones). *Let k be an ordered field, in this case the real numbers. The prop **PCRel** _{k} is defined as follows:*

- *Objects are natural numbers $n \in \mathbb{N}$, interpreted as the space k^n .*
- *A morphism $n \rightarrow m$ is a polyhedral cone $R \subseteq k^n \times k^m$ for which there exist $p \in \mathbb{N}$*

and $A \in k^{p \times (n+m)}$ such that

$$R = \left\{ (x, y) \in k^n \times k^m \mid A \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix} \geq 0 \right\}.$$

- *Composition is relational composition.*
- *The monoidal product on objects is addition $n \otimes m := n + m$, and on morphisms is the Cartesian product.*

Observe that in comparison with the previous categories of **AffRel**, this category is way more general although it does not completely encode the notion of Affine Spaces. However, it does introduce to us a somewhat unorthodox notion of conical polyhedral relations. That is, the fact that two elements x, y may be related to one another by a relation R such that the set of all pairs xRy form a polyhedral cone. Although this description remains very set-theoretically, it starts to flirt with the idea of x and y being apparted from a specific class of maps. More precisely, instead of thinking of the whole geometry of polyhedral cones, one may think of the pairs (x, y) such that $Ax \geq By$ for some A and B fully defined by the relation R .

1.2 SYNTAX: THE ALGEBRA $\mathbf{GPA}_{\perp}$

Definition 1.3 (Graphical Polyhedral Algebra). *We call **GPA** the SMT generated by extending **GAA** with the following generator and its semantics:*

$$\llbracket \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \rrbracket = \{(x, y) \mid x, y \in k, x \geq y\}$$

along with the following additional equations:

$$\begin{array}{lll}
 (P0) & \boxed{} & = \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \bigcirc \\
 (P1) & \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \bullet & \subseteq \text{---} \bullet \begin{array}{l} \swarrow \boxed{\geq} \\ \searrow \boxed{\geq} \end{array} \\
 (P2) & \bigcirc \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} & = \begin{array}{l} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \bigcirc \\ \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \bigcirc \end{array} \\
 (P3) & \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \bullet & = \text{---} \bullet \\
 (P4) & \bigcirc \text{---} & \subseteq \bigcirc \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---}
 \end{array}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
(P5) \quad k > 0 \quad & \boxed{k} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} = \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{k} \\
(P6) \quad k < 0 \quad & \boxed{k} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} = \text{---} \boxed{\leq} \text{---} \boxed{k} \\
(antisym) \quad & \text{---} \bullet \begin{array}{c} \boxed{\geq} \\ \boxed{\leq} \end{array} \bullet \text{---} \subseteq \text{---} \\
(spider) \quad & \begin{array}{c} \boxed{\geq} \\ \boxed{\geq} \end{array} \bullet \text{---} \bullet \begin{array}{c} \boxed{\geq} \\ \boxed{\geq} \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \boxed{\geq} \\ \boxed{\geq} \\ \boxed{\geq} \\ \boxed{\geq} \end{array} \\
(direction) \quad & \boxed{\leq} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} = \text{---} \bullet \bullet \text{---}
\end{aligned}$$

Definition 1.4 (Graphical Polyhedral Cones Algebra). *We call $\mathbf{GPA}_{\vdash}$ the SMT generated by $\mathbf{GPA}$ but excluding the affine generator $\vdash$ and its associated equations. This fragment axiomatises polyhedral cones, where no translation is present.*

Definition 1.5 (The Free Categories of Polyhedral Diagrams). *We call $\text{FreeP}_{\mathbf{GPA}}$ the PROP freely generated by $\mathbf{GPA}$, and $\text{FreeP}_{\mathbf{GPA}_{\vdash}}$ the PROP freely generated by $\mathbf{GPA}_{\vdash}$.*

1.3 THE ORDER STRUCTURE OF THE INEQUALITY GENERATOR

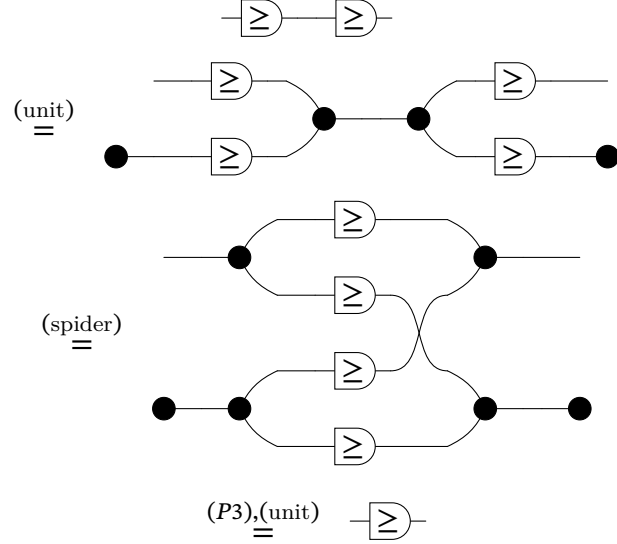
The central computational primitive for reasoning inside this algebra is Fourier–Motzkin Elimination, which projects a polyhedral cone onto a lower-dimensional space by eliminating one variable at a time.

It is worth being explicit about what that algorithm actually does to a system $Ax \geq 0$, because it fixes exactly which diagrammatic rules we have to establish first. To eliminate a variable t , the algorithm divides each row containing t by its coefficient, so that the row becomes a bound on t ; it records whether the bound is an upper or a lower one, according to the sign of that coefficient; and it then replaces the whole collection of bounds by one inequality for each upper–lower pair. Three moves, therefore: rescaling a row, moving a term across a sum, and merging bounds pairwise. Two of them are axioms of Definition 1.3; this section supplies the third and the order laws the axioms omit, and Section 1.4 assembles them into the elimination itself.

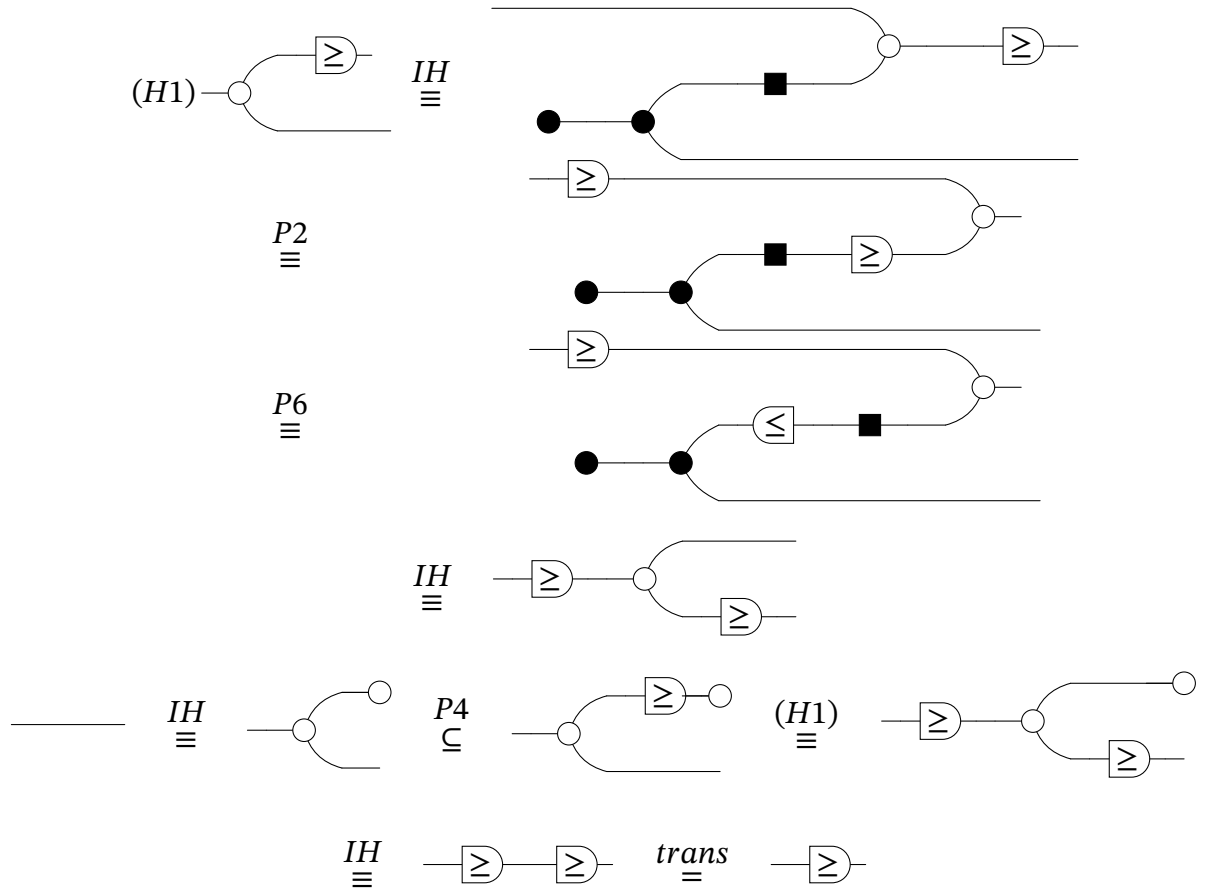
Rescaling and sign are given outright by (P5) and (P6), and the pairwise merge by (spider). What the axioms do not state, and what we need first, is that $\boxed{\geq}$ deserves its name: reflexivity and transitivity are not among them, and antisymmetry is postulated only as the inclusion $\subseteq$.

Lemma 1.1 (The generator is an order). *In $\mathbf{GPA}_{\perp}$ the generator $\dashv\!\!\!\geq$ is reflexive, transitive and antisymmetric.*

Proof. Transitivity is (spider) with one input fed by the black unit and one output discarded, the plugs being absorbed by (P3) and the black (co)unit laws:



For reflexivity we need a previous results that we call *H1*



Antisymmetry, the converse of the inclusion (antisym):

$$\begin{aligned}
(1) \quad & \text{---} \bullet \begin{array}{c} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \\ \text{---} \boxed{\leq} \text{---} \end{array} \bullet \text{---} \subseteq \text{---} \\
(2) \quad & \text{---} = \text{---} \bullet \text{---} \bullet \text{---} \subseteq \text{---} \bullet \begin{array}{c} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \\ \text{---} \boxed{\leq} \text{---} \end{array} \bullet \text{---} \\
(1) \wedge (2) \Rightarrow & \text{---} = \text{---} \bullet \begin{array}{c} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \\ \text{---} \boxed{\leq} \text{---} \end{array} \bullet \text{---}
\end{aligned}$$

□

Since $\text{---} \boxed{\leq} \text{---}$ is $\text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---}$ with an antipode on each side, by (P6) at $k = -1$, every axiom comes in a mirrored version, and we use both without further comment.

The move the axioms leave implicit is the transport of a term across a sum: it is the step that turns a row of a system into a bound on a single variable, and it is the content of the next lemma.

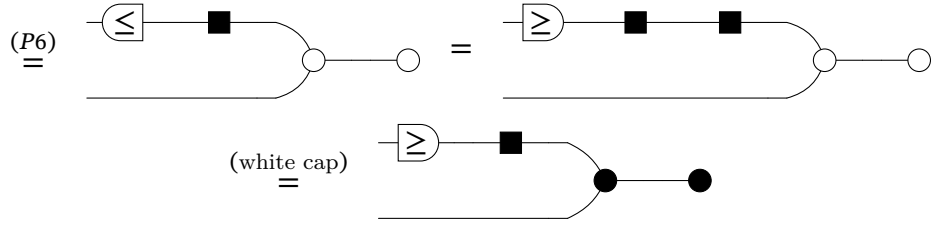
Lemma 1.2 (Cap form). *In $\mathbf{GPA}_{\perp}$,*

$$\begin{aligned}
(C1) \quad & \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \text{---} \bigcirc \text{---} = \text{---} \bigcirc \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} = \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \text{---} \bigcirc \text{---} \\
(C2) \quad & \text{---} \bigcirc \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \text{---} \bigcirc \text{---} = \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \text{---} \blacksquare \text{---}
\end{aligned}$$

The first chain reads $x + u \geq v$ iff $v - u \leq x$: an inequality may be applied before or after a sum indifferently. The second reads $s + u \geq 0$ iff $s \geq -u$, and it is the form we shall use: the diagram $(\text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \oplus \text{id}); \varepsilon$, whose denotation is $\{(\ell, r) \mid \ell \geq r\}$, we call the *cap form* of $\ell \geq r$, so that a row $s + u \geq 0$ of a system is the cap form of the bound $s \geq -u$.

Proof. Bending the second input of the white sum to an output is a bijection on hom-sets, so the first equation may be compared in bent form; the third follows by commutativity of the sum. Closing the bent leg with a white cozero then gives the second equation.

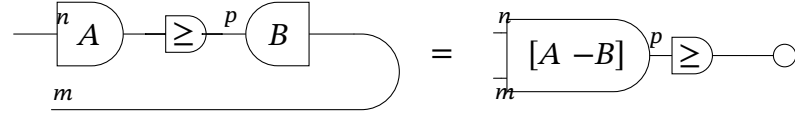
$$\begin{aligned}
(C1) \quad & \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \text{---} \bigcirc \text{---} = \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \text{---} \bigcirc \text{---} = \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \text{---} \bigcirc \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \\
& = \text{---} \bigcirc \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} = \text{---} \bigcirc \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \\
(C2) \quad & \text{---} \bigcirc \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \text{---} \bigcirc \text{---} \stackrel{(C1)}{=} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \text{---} \bigcirc \text{---} \text{---} \bigcirc \text{---}
\end{aligned}$$



□

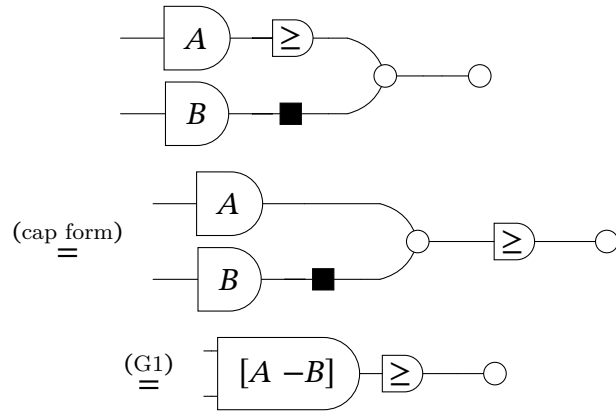
The same bending turns a two-sided system $Ax \geq By$ into a homogeneous one. This is the presentation in which elimination takes place, since it has a single block of rows and no distinguished side.

Lemma 1.3 (Cone form). *Let $A : n \rightarrow p$ and $B : m \rightarrow p$ be matrices. Bending the m outputs of A ; $-\left[\geq\right]^-; B^{\text{op}}$ into inputs yields the cone $[A \ -B]; -\left[\geq\right]^{-\oplus p}; \text{coz}^{\oplus p}$, and unbending recovers the original diagram.*



That is, $\exists v. Ax \geq v, v = By$ iff $Ax - By \geq 0$. Rescaling the rows of a cone by positive constants leaves it unchanged, since $Dz \geq 0$ iff $z \geq 0$ for diagonal $D > 0$; this is (P5) again, applied row by row.

Proof. Bending the comatrix exposes a white sum with an antipode on one leg, and the cap form pushes the inequality past it.



□

The third move, the pairwise merge, is (spider). It is the only one of the three that is not local: on its left-hand side a black node forces a single intermediate value below every x_i and above every y_j , and on its right-hand side that value is gone and only the relations $x_i \geq y_j$ survive. The axiom is therefore the elimination of an intermediate variable in the form discussed in the introduction, and the number of rows grows from $a + b$ to ab exactly as it does in the classical algorithm.

1.4 FOURIER–MOTZKIN ELIMINATION

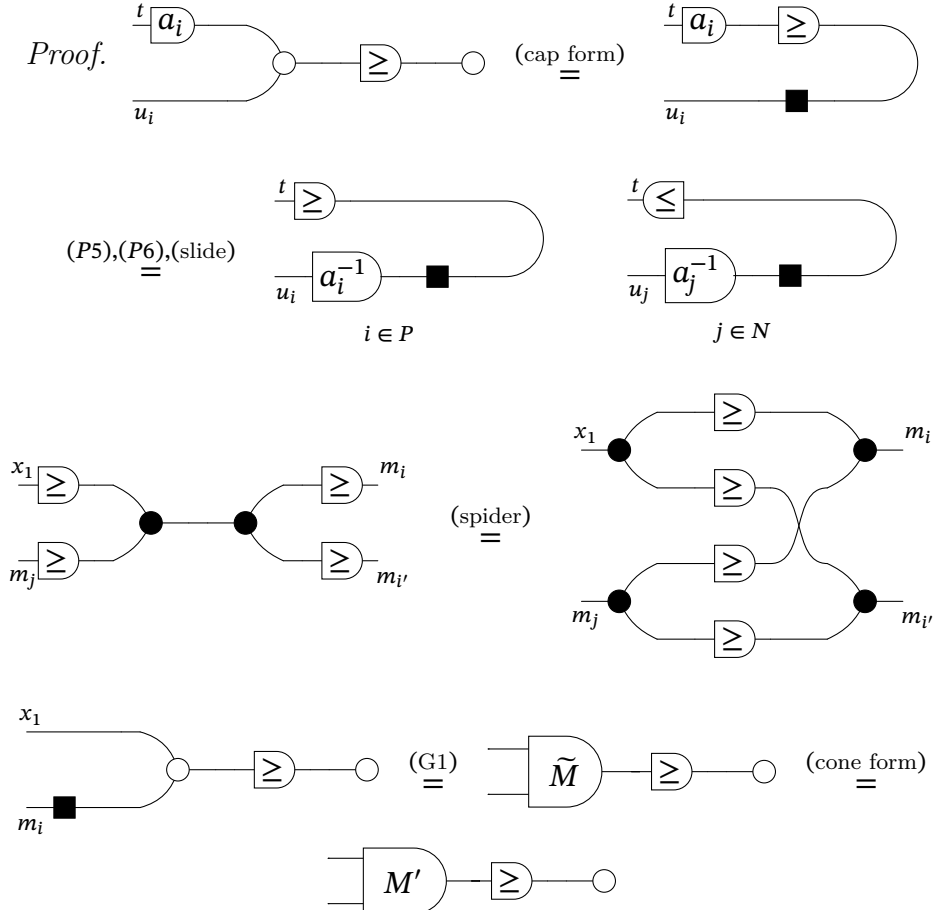
With the three moves available we can eliminate a single variable. Let $M \in \mathbb{R}^{p \times q}$ have first column a , and split the row indices into $P = \{i \mid a_i > 0\}$, $N = \{j \mid a_j < 0\}$ and $Z = \{i \mid a_i = 0\}$.

Lemma 1.4 (One elimination step). *Let M' be the matrix with rows M_i for $i \in P \cup Z$ and $|a_j|M_i + a_i M_j$ for $(i, j) \in P \times N$, so that $p' = |P| + |Z| + |P||N|$. Then*

$$\begin{array}{c} 1 \\ \geq \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \text{---} \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} p \\ \geq \end{array} \text{---} \bigcirc = \begin{array}{c} 1 \\ \geq \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \text{---} \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} p' \\ \geq \end{array} \text{---} \bigcirc$$

$q-1$ $q-1$

Write t for the wire leaving the generator, x_r for the remaining inputs, $u_i = (M_r x_r)_i$ and $m_i = -u_i/a_i$. Row i of the system reads $a_i t + u_i \geq 0$; the rows in Z do not mention t and are carried along unchanged.



The first line brings a row to cap form and divides by its coefficient, so that it becomes $t \geq m_i$ for $i \in P$ and $t \leq m_j$ for $j \in N$. The second merges the bounds by (spider), the m_j legs having been slid across their caps so that the node carries an inequality on every leg. The third relinearises the resulting pairs and rescales them by the positive constants a_i and $a_i|a_j|$. When $P = \emptyset$ every bound is discarded by (P3), which is the statement that t

may be chosen arbitrarily small; when $N = \emptyset$ nothing is bent and the node is just copied by (P1). $\square$

Iterating the step eliminates the variables bound by the outer generators one at a time, which is the diagrammatic FME.

Proposition 1.1 (Fourier-Motzkin Elimination). *The following diagrammatic procedure is equivalent to perform the FME algorithm*

$$\text{---} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline A \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline B \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---} = \text{---} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline A' \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline B' \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---}$$

A pair (x, y) is related by $\text{---} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---}; g; \text{---} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---}$ precisely when there are v, w with $x \geq v$, $(v, w) \in \llbracket g \rrbracket$ and $w \geq y$, so the two bound variables v, w are what the elimination has to remove.

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{Proof. } \text{---} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline g \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---} \\ & \stackrel{(G2)}{=} \text{---} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline E \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline k \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline F \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---} \\ & \stackrel{(\text{bend})}{=} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \leq \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline [E - F]^k \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---} \\ & \stackrel{(\text{antipode})}{=} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline M_1 \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline 2k \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---} \\ & \stackrel{(FME)}{=} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline M_2 \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline p \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---} \\ & \stackrel{(\text{unbend})}{=} \text{---} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline A' \\ \hline \end{array} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline \geq \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---} \begin{array}{|c|} \hline B' \\ \hline \end{array} \text{---} \end{aligned}$$

The cospan form (G2) presents the middle condition as an equation, which the cone form (Lemma 1.3) and the antipode turn into a single block M_1 of $2k$ rows; Lemma 1.4, applied $n + m$ times, eliminates the bound variables and leaves M_2 ; unbending the last m inputs returns the claimed shape. The rows coming from the middle equations are never eliminated and simply survive in the final cone. $\square$

With FME available as a diagrammatic operation, we can now prove the normal form theorem for $\mathbf{GPA}_+$. We proceed by structural induction, handling generators, composition, and tensor product in turn, using FME steps to push all inequality generators into a canonical block form.

Theorem 1.1 (First Normal Form). *Every diagram in $\mathbf{GPA}_+$ admits an isomorphic representation, modulo the axioms, of the following form:*

$$\text{---} \boxed{A} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{B} \text{---}$$

Proof. We proceed by structural induction. The two base cases are as follows. First, the $\geq$ generator:

$$\boxed{\geq} = \boxed{} \boxed{\geq} \boxed{} = \text{---} \boxed{I} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{I} \text{---}$$

Second, for any diagram c in $\mathbf{GLA}$:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{---} \boxed{A} \text{---} &= \text{---} \boxed{A} \text{---} \bullet \begin{array}{c} \boxed{\geq} \\ \boxed{\leq} \end{array} \bullet \text{---} \\ &= \bullet \begin{array}{c} \boxed{A} \boxed{\geq} \\ \boxed{A} \boxed{\leq} \end{array} \bullet \quad (\text{antipode}) \quad \bullet \begin{array}{c} \boxed{A} \boxed{\geq} \\ \boxed{-A} \boxed{\geq} \end{array} \bullet \\ &\stackrel{(\text{matrix def.})}{=} \text{---} \boxed{\bar{A}} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{\bar{B}} \text{---} \end{aligned}$$

For the inductive step, we consider composition of two diagrams $c; d$ in $\mathbf{GPA}_+$. By the inductive hypothesis, both c and d are already in normal form:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{---} \boxed{A} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{B} \text{---} \quad ; \quad \text{---} \boxed{C} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{D} \text{---} \\ &= \text{---} \boxed{A} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{B} \boxed{C} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{D} \text{---} \\ &\stackrel{(FME)}{=} \text{---} \boxed{\hat{A}} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{\hat{D}} \text{---} \end{aligned}$$

And for the tensor product:

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{---} \boxed{A} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{B} \text{---} \\ \text{---} \boxed{C} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{D} \text{---} \end{array} = \text{---} \boxed{\bar{A}} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{\bar{B}} \text{---}$$

□

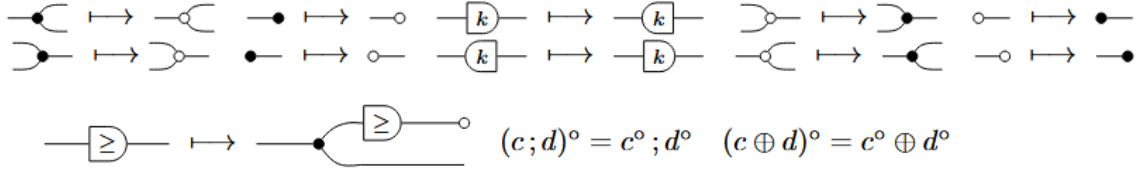
Working with a normal form defined up to isomorphism is in principle weaker than requiring syntactic equality of terms. This choice is motivated by the compact-closed structure, which provides a canonical bijection $\text{Hom}(A, B) \cong \text{Hom}(1, A^* \otimes B)$, allowing input wires to be treated symmetrically with output wires but only up to this isomorphism, not up to equality. As shown in [BDS21], the same completeness argument can be carried out using strict diagrammatic equality; however, the derivations become significantly more involved. Since every result established for the isomorphic normal form carries over to the

strict one, the only difference being the need to bend wires at each step, we adopt the more convenient convention throughout.

This idea was already encountered in the treatment of Graphical Quadratic Algebra [Ste+24], but it is worth pausing to appreciate its significance. The compact-closed structure does not merely allow a more convenient notation; it enables diagrammatic reasoning to serve as a rigorous replacement for coordinate-based algebraic manipulation while remaining extremely intuitive: bending a wire to the left or to the right does exactly what one would expect. Even more, a statement that would classically require several lines of matrix algebra, tracking indices, transposing, and substituting, can instead be verified by a sequence of local wire manipulations, each justified by a single axiom.

This first normal form expresses every diagram as a system of inequalities applied to a linear map. A dual normal form can be obtained by applying the polar operator, which we now define. The polar operator plays the role of duality in the polyhedral setting, exchanging the H -representation (intersection of halfspaces) with the V -representation (conic hull of generators), in direct analogy with the Farkas lemma [BDZ21].

Definition 1.6 (Polar Operator). *The polar operator $-^\circ$ is the involution on generators defined by:*



Its action on diagrams is defined functorially by $(a \circ b)^\circ = a^\circ \circ b^\circ$.

Proposition 1.2 (Second Normal Form). *Every diagram $s \in \mathbf{GPA}_\perp$ can be written as:*

$$\left(\text{---} \boxed{A} \text{---} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \boxed{B} \text{---} \right)^\circ = \text{---} \boxed{A^T} \text{---} \bullet \begin{cases} \boxed{\geq} \text{---} \circ \\ \boxed{B^T} \text{---} \end{cases}$$

Proof. Apply the polar operator to the first normal form of every diagram $c \in \mathbf{GPA}_\perp$. Since the polar operator is an involution and acts functorially, the result is again a valid diagram in $\mathbf{GPA}_\perp$ in the claimed form. $\square$

The second normal form expresses every diagram as a conic combination of column vectors, which is precisely the V -representation of a polyhedral cone. This is the representation that will drive the completeness proof: two diagrams that are semantically equal must have the same conic hull, and the axioms of $\mathbf{GPA}_\perp$ are exactly sufficient to witness this equality diagrammatically.

1.5 PRESENTATION RESULTS FOR **PCREL**

We now develop the presentation theory for the homogeneous case, proceeding to establish the three properties that together yield the presentation of **PCRel**.

Lemma 1.5 (Soundness). *If $s = t$ in $\text{FreeP}_{\mathbf{GPA}_\perp}$, then $[s] = [t]$ in **PCRel**.*

Proof. All axioms except those involving the newly introduced $\geq$ generator are already present in **GAA** and therefore verified. It suffices to check that the new axioms preserve the semantics:

$$[\neg \otimes] = \{ (x, y_1, y_2) \mid x \geq y_1 \wedge x \geq y_2 \wedge y_1 = y_2 \} \\ \subseteq \{ (x, y_1, y_2) \mid x \geq y_1 \wedge x \geq y_2 \} = [\neg \otimes]$$

$$[\rightarrow \otimes] = \{ (x_1, x_2, y) \mid x_1 + x_2 \geq y \} =$$

$$\{ (x_1, x_2, y) \mid \exists c, d \ x_1 + x_2 \geq c + d \wedge c + d = y \} =$$

$$\{ (x_1, x_2, y) \mid \exists \hat{c}, \hat{d} \ x_1 \geq \hat{c} \wedge x_2 \geq \hat{d} \wedge \hat{c} + \hat{d} = y \} = [\rightarrow \otimes]$$

$$[\neg \otimes] = \{ (x, 0) \mid \exists c \ x \geq c \} \stackrel{\text{tautology}}{=} \{ (x, 0) \mid x \in \overline{\mathbb{R}} \} = [\neg]$$

$$[\neg] = \{ (x, 0) \mid x = 0 \} \stackrel{\text{tautology}}{=} \{ (x, 0) \mid x \geq 0 \wedge x = 0 \} \\ \subseteq \{ (x, 0) \mid x \geq 0 \} = [\neg \otimes]$$

$$\begin{aligned} &_{>0} [\neg \otimes \neg \otimes] = \{ (x, y) \mid x \geq y \wedge K > 0 \} = \{ (x, y) \mid x \geq y \wedge K > 0 \} \\ &= \{ (x, y) \mid \exists c \ x \geq c \wedge Kc = y \wedge K > 0 \} = [\neg \otimes \neg \otimes] \end{aligned}$$

$$_{K < 0} [\neg \otimes \neg \otimes] = \text{Same as above, flip the } \geq = [\neg \otimes \neg \otimes]$$

$$\left[\begin{array}{c} \text{---} \bullet \text{---} \text{---} \bullet \text{---} \\ \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \end{array} \right] = \{ (x, y) \mid x \geq y \wedge x \leq y \} =$$

$$\{ (x, y) \mid x = y \wedge x, y \in \mathbb{R} \} \subseteq \{ (x, y) \mid x = y \wedge x, y \in \overline{\mathbb{R}} \} \\ = \text{---}$$

$$\left[\begin{array}{c} \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \\ \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \end{array} \right] = \{ (x_1, y_1) \mid \exists z \ x_1 \geq z \wedge x_2 \geq z \wedge z \geq y_1 \wedge z \geq y_2 \}$$

$$= \{ (x_1, y_1) \mid x_1 \geq y_1 \wedge x_1 \geq y_2 \wedge x_2 \geq y_1 \wedge x_2 \geq y_2 \}$$

$$= \left[\begin{array}{c} \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \\ \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \end{array} \right]$$

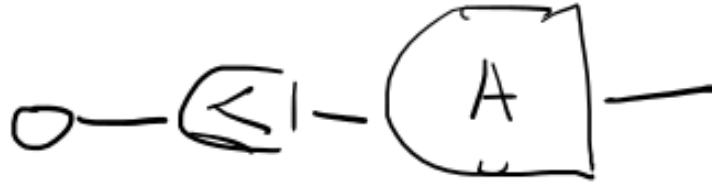
$$\left[\begin{array}{c} \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \\ \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \text{---} \end{array} \right] = \{ (x, y) \mid \exists z \ z \geq y \wedge z \geq x \} =$$

$$= \{ (x, y) \mid x, y \in \overline{\mathbb{R}} \} = \text{---}$$

□

Lemma 1.6 (Expressivity). *For every $f : m \rightarrow n$ in **PCRel** there exists a Σ -term $s : m \rightarrow n$ in $\text{Hom}_{\text{FreeP}_{\text{GPA}}}(m, n)$ such that $[s] = f$.*

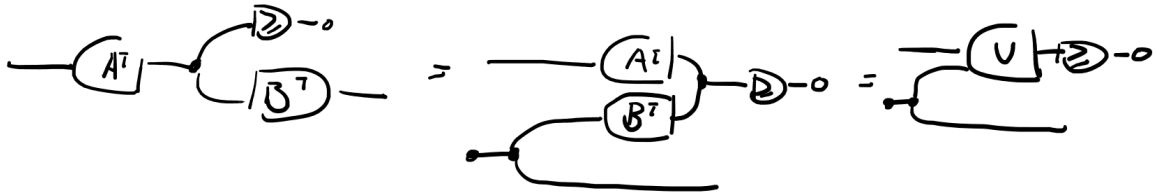
Proof. By Definition 1.1, every polyhedral cone has the form $\{x \mid Ax \geq 0, x \in \mathbb{R}^n\}$. This is precisely the interpretation of the diagram:



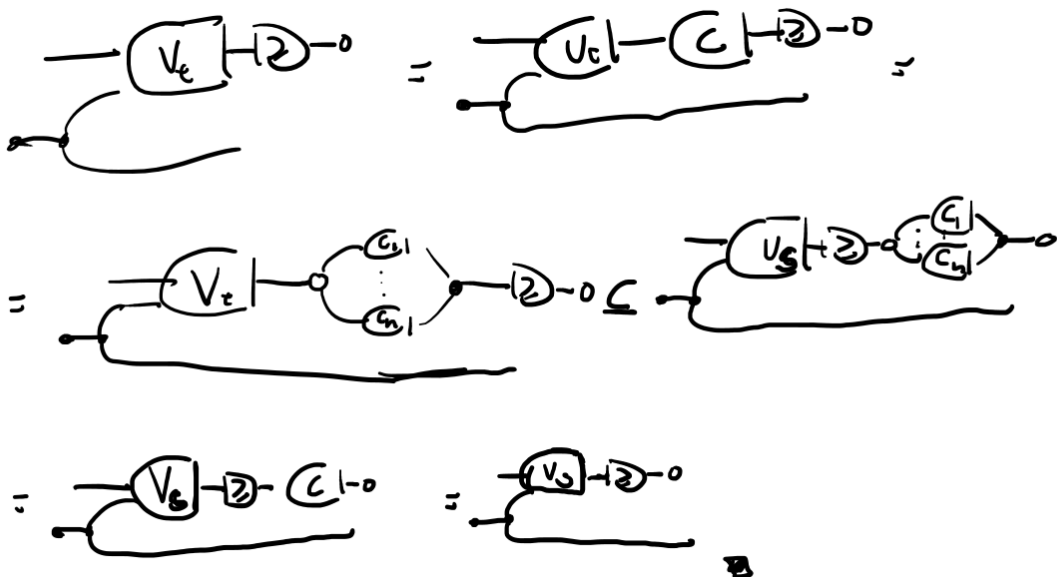
□

Lemma 1.7 (Completeness). *If $[s] = [t]$ in $\mathbf{PCRel}$, then $s = t$ in $\text{FreeP}_{\mathbf{GPA}_\perp}$.*

Proof. By the second normal form, we write s and t in V -representation form:



The semantics of such a diagram is the conic hull of the column vectors of V . Since $[s] = [t]$ implies in particular $[s] \subseteq [t]$, the conic combinations of V_t are a subset of those of V_s . Hence there exists a non-negative matrix C such that $CV_t = V_s$. The diagrammatic witness is:



The inclusion $[s] \subseteq [t]$ follows by the same argument, yielding equality. $\square$

Theorem 1.2. *PCRel is presented by $\text{FreeP}_{\mathbf{GPA}_{\perp}}$.*

Proof. Soundness, expressivity, and completeness were established by the preceding three lemmas. Together they imply that the canonical PROP morphism is an isomorphism. $\square$

This settles the homogeneous case: every polyhedral cone is diagrammatically expressible, and two diagrams denote the same cone exactly when the axioms can prove them equal. Cones are, however, a narrow class, they always contain the origin, so they cannot represent an arbitrary feasible region or, later, an arbitrary linear program. The next step lifts this result from cones to general polyhedra, replacing the homogeneous inequalities $Ax \geq 0$ with the affine $Ax \geq b$, and the machinery developed above will carry over almost unchanged.

1.6 SEMANTICS: THE PROP **POLYREL** OF POLYHEDRA

Now we start the presentation of the broader class of polyhedral relations by recalling the definition of a polyhedron.

Definition 1.7. *A set $P \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ is called a polyhedron if there exist $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$ and $b \in \mathbb{R}^m$ such that*

$$P = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^n \mid Ax \geq b\}.$$

Note that a polyhedral cone is a special case of a polyhedron with $b = 0$. The distinction is algebraically significant: cones are closed under non-negative scaling and admit a purely homogeneous representation, while general polyhedra may be translated. This distinction is reflected in the two graphical algebras we now define, where $\mathbf{GPA}_{\perp}$ handles the homogeneous case and $\mathbf{GPA}$ extends it with an affine generator.

In that light, one can define the category of polyhedral relations as:

Definition 1.8 (The prop **PolyRel** of polyhedra). *Let k be an ordered field. The prop $\mathbf{PolyRel}_k$ is defined as follows:*

- *Objects are natural numbers $n \in \mathbb{N}$, interpreted as the space k^n .*
- *A morphism $n \rightarrow m$ is a polyhedron $R \subseteq k^n \times k^m$ for which there exist $p \in \mathbb{N}$, $A \in k^{p \times (n+m)}$, and $b \in k^p$ such that*

$$R = \left\{ (x, y) \in k^n \times k^m \mid A \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix} + b \geq 0 \right\}.$$

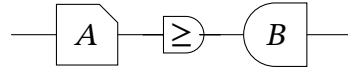
- *Composition is relational composition.*
- *The monoidal product on objects is addition $n \otimes m := n + m$, and on morphisms is the Cartesian product.*

Notice how, the same way that **PCRel** offered us a more relational way to think about Polyhedral Cones, so does **PolyRel**. Indeed, one may think of polyhedrals as closed spaces in some geometry that respects some linear constraints. We argue, however, that this definition is overly convoluted, and a more natural way to denote such objects is to think in terms of relations R , such that $xRy \iff Ax + b \geq By + c$ for some matrices A, B and vectors b, c . Once again, we move from a set-theoretic heavy description to a more logical one.

1.7 SYNTAX: THE ALGEBRA **GPA**

We now extend the theory from polyhedral cones to general polyhedra by reintroducing the affine generator $\vdash$. Geometrically, this corresponds to allowing translations: a polyhedron is a translated polyhedral cone, and the generator $\vdash$ provides the syntactic means to encode the right-hand side vector b in $Ax \geq b$. The normal form, soundness, and expressivity arguments all extend smoothly from the homogeneous case.

Theorem 1.3 (Normal Form). *For every diagram c in **GPA**, there exists a diagram d such that $c = d$ modulo the axioms and d is of the form:*



Proof. The derivation proceeds directly. Let c be a diagram of **GPA**. Then we can collect all $\vdash$ on the left such that c' is a diagram of **GPA** $_{\vdash}$

$$\boxed{c} = \begin{array}{c} \text{---} \\ \vdash \end{array} \boxed{c'} \text{---}$$

From Theorem 1.1 we know that c' admits a normal form in terms of matrices A and B . Breaking down the matrix A in columns we get:

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= \vdash \boxed{A} - \boxed{B} \vdash \\
 &= \begin{array}{c} \vdash \boxed{\bar{A}} \\ \vdash \boxed{b} \end{array} \rightarrow \boxed{B} \vdash
 \end{aligned}$$

thus the thesis. $\square$

1.8 PRESENTATION RESULTS FOR **POLYREL**

Lemma 1.8 (Soundness). *If $s = t$ in $\text{FreeP}_{\text{GPA}}$, then $[s] = [t]$ in **PolyRel**.*

Proof. This follows immediately from the soundness of **PCRel**. Since the generator $\vdash$ introduces no new axioms beyond those already verified for **PCRel** and **GAA**, and both of those theories are sound in **PolyRel**, soundness carries over directly. $\square$

Lemma 1.9 (Expressivity). *For every $f : m \rightarrow n$ in **PolyRel** there exists a Σ -term $s : m \rightarrow n$ in $\text{Hom}_{\text{FreeP}_{\text{GPA}}}(m, n)$ such that $[s] = f$.*

Proof. By Definition 1.7, every polyhedron has the form $\{x \mid Ax \geq b\}$. Appealing to this representation directly, the polyhedron is expressed as the interpretation of the following diagram, where the generator $\vdash$ encodes the right-hand side vector b :

$$\left[\vdash \boxed{b} - \leq \vdash \boxed{A} \vdash \right] = \{ (b, x) \mid Ax \geq b, x \in \mathbb{R}^n \}$$

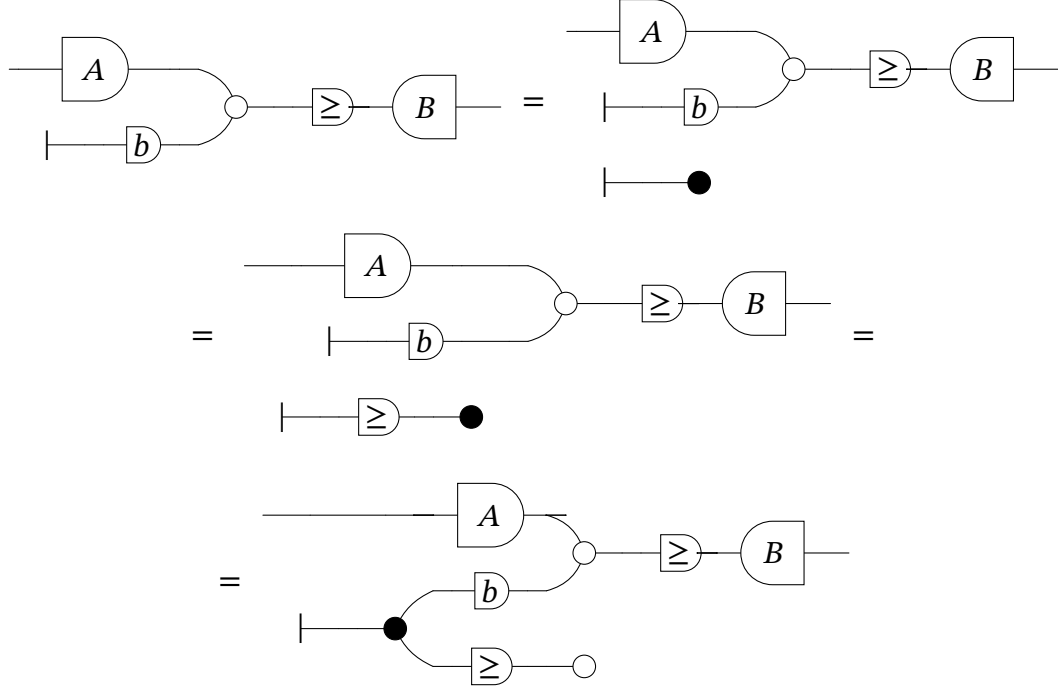
$\square$

Lemma 1.10 (Completeness). *If $[s] = [t]$ in **PolyRel**, then $s = t$ in $\text{FreeP}_{\text{GPA}}$.*

Proof. Every polyhedron P can be homogenised by introducing a slack variable, reducing the affine case to the conic one $P^H = \{(x, y) \in k^{n+1} \mid Ax + by \geq 0, y \geq 0\}$ which admits a

normal form (Theorem 1.1). Under this homogenisation, for each two diagrams $s, t \in \mathbf{GPA}$ with $[s] = [t]$ in $\mathbf{PolyRel}$, there are s', t' in $\mathbf{GPA}_\perp$ such that $[s'] = [s]^H, [t'] = [t]^H$. Since two polyhedrals P, Q are equal iff $P^H = Q^H$, then s and t have equal semantics in $\mathbf{PCRel}$. Completeness of $\mathbf{GPA}_\perp$ then gives equality of the homogenised diagrams, and de-homogenising recovers equality of s and t in $\mathbf{FreeP}_{\mathbf{GPA}}$.

Diagrammatically this goes as follows:



Whereas the interpretation of the last diagram is $\{(x, y, z) \in k^m \mid Ax + by \geq Bz, y \geq 0\}$, which is the same as P^H . Therefore, the semantics of s' is that of the homogenisation of $[s]$ and follows the above argument. $\square$

Theorem 1.4. $\mathbf{PolyRel}$ is presented by $\mathbf{FreeP}_{\mathbf{GPA}}$.

Proof. By the preceding three lemmas. $\square$

This is the result the rest of the thesis leans on: every polyhedral relation, not just the conic ones from earlier, has a diagrammatic representative, and semantic equality between polyhedra can always be certified by a finite rewriting sequence in $\mathbf{GPA}$. It is this presentation, together with its normal form, that Chapter 2 builds on when it adds a single new generator for the objective function.

Remark 1.1 (Invariance under non-negative matrices). *Whereas the linearity axiom shows the linear generator to be exactly invariant under column-stochastic reweightings (Remark 2.1), the order generator ge enjoys a related but weaker property with respect to non-negative matrices. Let $A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times m}$ with $A_{ij} \geq 0$ for all i, j . If $x, y \in \mathbb{R}^m$ satisfy $x \geq y$*

componentwise, then $Ax \geq Ay$ componentwise: for each row i ,

$$(Ax)_i - (Ay)_i = \sum_j A_{ij}(x_j - y_j) \geq 0,$$

since every term is a product of a non-negative entry and a non-negative difference. Diagrammatically, this is the inclusion

$$\text{matrix}[A] ; \text{ge}^{\otimes n} \subseteq \text{ge}^{\otimes m} ; \text{matrix}[A]^{\otimes 2},$$

verified directly in the semantics of **PolyRel**, exactly as the axioms of **GPA** are themselves verified. Unlike Remark 2.1, this is only an inclusion and not an equality: a non-negative matrix need not reflect the order, only preserve it, so $Ax \geq Ay$ can hold even when $x \geq y$ fails (take $A = \mathbf{0}$). In other words, a non-negative matrix always goes through the order generator, certifying that any inequality derived in **GPA** remains valid after left multiplication by A .

2 THE LINEAR PROGRAMMING CATEGORY

The theory developed so far has extended the categorical framework by adding a new class of morphisms. We now introduce the final and most expressive theory of the thesis: a graphical algebra for parametric linear programs. Linear programs combine both the inequality structure of polyhedra and the notion of an objective function, and their value functions are precisely the polyhedral convex functions. The central result of this section is the presentation of a complete monoidal theory for right-hand side parametric linear programming.

2.1 SEMANTICS: THE PROP **LPREL**

We begin with several classical results that establish the tight relationship between piecewise affine convex functions, polyhedral functions, and parametric linear programs. These will serve as the semantic foundation for the graphical algebra introduced in the following section, and they justify describing the morphisms of this chapter's semantic category, **LPREL**, interchangeably as parametric linear programs or as polyhedral functions.

Definition 2.1 (Piecewise Affine Convex Function). *A function $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is called piecewise affine convex if there exist finitely many affine functions $a_i^\top x + b_i$, $i = 1, \dots, k$, such that*

$$f(x) = \max_{i=1, \dots, k} \{a_i^\top x + b_i\}.$$

Definition 2.2 (Polyhedral Function). *A function $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \cup \{+\infty\}$ is polyhedral if its epigraph*

$$\text{epi}(f) := \{(x, t) \mid t \geq f(x)\}$$

is a polyhedron.

Definition 2.3 (RHS Parametric Linear Program). *A right-hand side parametric linear program has value function*

$$v(b) := \inf_x \{c^\top x \mid Ax \geq b\}.$$

The following two propositions establish that all three notions above are equivalent descriptions of the same class of functions. This equivalence is the semantic cornerstone of the section: it is what allows us to treat polyhedral functions and parametric linear programs as morphisms in the same category.

Proposition 2.1. *A function is piecewise affine convex if and only if it is a polyhedral function.*

Proof. ($\Rightarrow$) Let $f(x) = \max_{i=1,\dots,k}(a_i^\top x + b_i)$. Then

$$\text{epi}(f) = \bigcap_{i=1}^k \{(x, t) \mid t \geq a_i^\top x + b_i\},$$

which is an intersection of finitely many halfspaces, hence a polyhedron.

($\Leftarrow$) If f is polyhedral, its epigraph is a polyhedron, so there exist finitely many affine inequalities $t \geq a_i^\top x + b_i$ such that $f(x) = \max_{i=1,\dots,k}(a_i^\top x + b_i)$. Thus f is piecewise affine and convex. $\square$

Proposition 2.2. *A function $v : \mathbb{R}^m \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \cup \{+\infty\}$ is piecewise affine convex if and only if it is the value function of a right-hand side parametric linear program.*

Proof. ($\Rightarrow$) Let $v(b) = \max_{i=1,\dots,k}(y^i)^\top b$ and define $Y := \text{conv}\{y^1, \dots, y^k\}$. Then $v(b) = \max_{y \in Y} b^\top y$. Since Y is a polyhedron admitting the representation $Y = \{y \mid A^\top y = c, y \geq 0\}$, linear programming duality gives $v(b) = \inf\{c^\top x \mid Ax \geq b\}$.

($\Leftarrow$) Let $v(b) = \inf\{c^\top x \mid Ax \geq b\}$. Dualising, $v(b) = \sup\{b^\top y \mid A^\top y = c, y \geq 0\}$. Since the feasible set $Y = \{y \mid A^\top y = c, y \geq 0\}$ is a polyhedron, the supremum is attained at its extreme points $y^1, \dots, y^k$, yielding $v(b) = \max_{i=1,\dots,k}(y^i)^\top b$. Thus v is piecewise affine convex. $\square$

The following proposition is the key technical lemma for the completeness proof of **GLP**. It states that two parametric linear programs with the same value function must share the same epigraph polyhedron, providing the bridge between semantic equality and polyhedral equality that the completeness argument requires.

Proposition 2.3. *Let*

$$v_i(y) := \inf\{1^\top x \mid A_i x \geq B_i y\}, \quad i = 1, 2,$$

where $A_i \in \mathbb{R}^{m_i \times n_i}$ and $B_i \in \mathbb{R}^{m_i \times k}$. If $v_1(y) = v_2(y)$ for all $y \in \mathbb{R}^k$, then both programs admit a common representation through the same epigraph polyhedron:

$$v_i(y) = \inf\{t \mid (y, t) \in E\}, \quad E := \text{epi}(v_1) = \text{epi}(v_2).$$

Proof. For each $i = 1, 2$, the epigraph of v_i satisfies

$$(y, t) \in \text{epi}(v_i) \iff \exists x : A_i x \geq B_i y, 1^\top x \leq t,$$

so $\text{epi}(v_i)$ is the projection onto (y, t) of the polyhedron $P_i = \{(x, y, t) \mid A_i x \geq B_i y, 1^\top x \leq t\}$. Projections of polyhedra are polyhedra, so each $\text{epi}(v_i)$ is a polyhedron. Since $v_1 = v_2$ pointwise, we have $\text{epi}(v_1) = \text{epi}(v_2) =: E$. Setting $E = \{(y, t) \mid Cy + dt \geq 0\}$, we obtain $v_i(y) = \inf\{t \mid Cy + dt \geq 0\}$ for both $i = 1, 2$. $\square$

With the equivalences above in place, we now define the semantic category of this chapter. **LPrel** describes morphisms as parametric linear programs; by the propositions above, these coincide with polyhedral functions, and we will use both descriptions interchangeably according to which is more convenient.

Definition 2.4 (The prop **LPrel** of Linear Programs). *The prop **LPrel** is defined as follows:*

- Objects are natural numbers $n \in \mathbb{N}$, interpreted as the space $\mathbb{R}^n$.
- A morphism $n \rightarrow m$ is a right-hand side parametric linear program with value function

$$(x, y) \mapsto \inf_z \{c^\top z \mid Az \geq B[x \ y]^\top\},$$

where $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$ and $y \in \mathbb{R}^m$.

- Composition is given by minimisation over the shared variable.
- The monoidal product on objects is addition $n \otimes m := n + m$, and on morphisms is direct sum.

2.2 SYNTAX: THE ALGEBRA **GLP**

With the semantic equivalences established, we now introduce the final graphical algebra of the thesis. The algebra **GLP** extends **GPA** with a single new generator whose semantics encodes the linear objective function $c^\top x$. Just as the gray arrow in **GQA** lifted the theory from binary relations to weighted relations by "measuring" the ℓ_2 norm, this new generator lifts **GPA** from polyhedral constraints to full linear programs by attaching a linear cost to the feasible region.

Definition 2.5 (GLP). *We call **GLP** the symmetric monoidal theory obtained by extending **GPA** with the following generator:*

$$\llbracket \square \text{---} \rrbracket = (\bullet, x) \mapsto x$$

together with the following axioms governing its interaction with the existing generators:

$$\begin{array}{lll}
 \text{(linearity)} & \begin{array}{c} \square \text{---} \\ \square \text{---} \end{array} & = \begin{array}{c} \square \text{---} \bigcirc \end{array} \\
 \text{(zeroeq)} & \begin{array}{c} \square \text{---} \bigcirc \end{array} & = \begin{array}{c} \square \end{array} \\
 \text{(inf)} & \begin{array}{c} \square \text{---} \square \geq \end{array} & = \begin{array}{c} \square \text{---} \end{array}
 \end{array}$$

The axioms represent expected properties of the linear cost function. The one on the left express the linear property $f(x) + f(y) = f(x + y)$. Observe that f is the interpretation of the $\sqcup -$ and the sum denotes the vertical composition; composing two $\sqcup -$ vertically (adding) is the same as adding the wires in a single $\sqcup -$. This axiom is also the fundamental property of LPs, which is the fact that they are invariant to column stochastic matrices (see 2.1). In turn, the equation on the right express the fundamental property of minimization, the infimum of any quantity lies in its lower bound.

$$\inf_x \{x \mid x \geq y\} = y$$

Finally, the axiom at the middle is the tautological case.

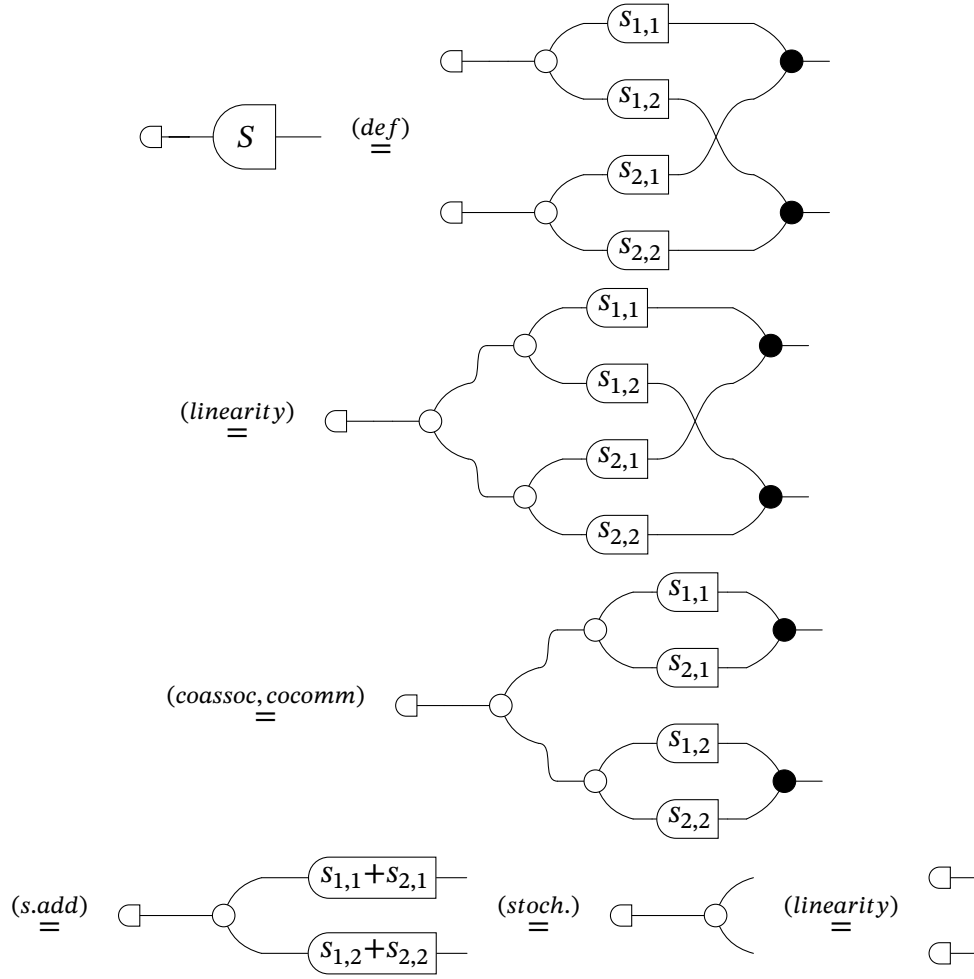
$$\inf 0 = 0$$

From this simple axioms, we get immediatly another core property of linear programs, namely, that they are invariant to stochastics matrices.

Remark 2.1 (Invariance under column-stochastic matrices). *The linearity axiom encodes the fundamental invariance of linear programs under column-stochastic reweightings of the objective: for any $n \times m$ matrix S whose columns each sum to one,*

$$\sqcup -^{\otimes n}; S^{op} = \sqcup -^{\otimes m},$$

where S^{op} denotes the comatrix of S . Note that only the column sums are used; non-negativity of the entries plays no role. The proof is diagrammatic, we display the proof for a 2×2 matrix S with $s_{1,1} + s_{2,1} = s_{1,2} + s_{2,2} = 1$; every step is an instance of an axiom scheme that applies wire-by-wire, so the same chain of rewrites goes through verbatim for arbitrary $n \times m$.



Such result is particularly interesting because it follows a pattern present in every algebra presented so far. In the digrammatic calculi of Linear subspaces (GLA) we can demonstrate that surjective matrices are very special because the $\bullet$ is invariant to it, which is a very important feature in the completeness of the language itself. The same occurs in GPA, where non-negative matrices slide through the $\begin{smallmatrix} \square \\ \geq \end{smallmatrix}$. Here, the new class of matrices that interact with the new generator $\square$ is that of stochastic matrices. Other works have spotted the same pattern, such as [Ste+24] which shows that a generator representing the l_2 norm is invariant to orthogonal matrices (also are normal distributed random variables).

Is not yet entirely clear the relationship between each class of morphisms and that class of matrices and how they emerge. However is a signature and very interesting property of such languages.

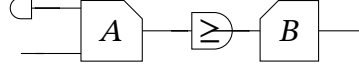
With the SMT above we now define the complete category.

Definition 2.6. We call $\text{FreeP}_{\text{GLP}}$ the PROP freely generated by GLP.

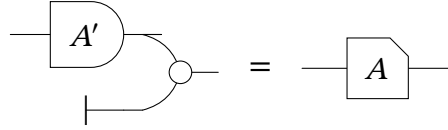
The normal form theorem for **GLP** extends the one for **GPA**: every diagram can be reduced to a **GPA** block encoding the constraints, composed with the new generator

encoding the objective. The proof proceeds by structural induction, using the existing normal form for **GPA** as the inductive base.

Theorem 2.1 (Normal Form). *For every diagram $c \in \mathbf{GLP}$, there exists a diagram c' in normal form such that $c = c'$:*

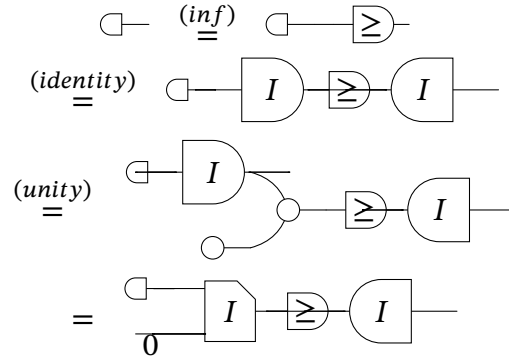


With A and b being an affine transformation. Namely:

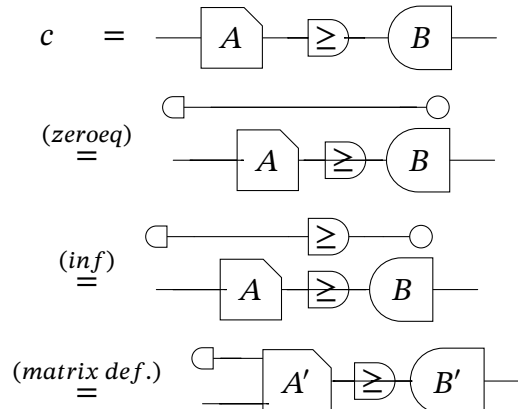


Proof. The proof is by structural induction. First we show the two base cases:

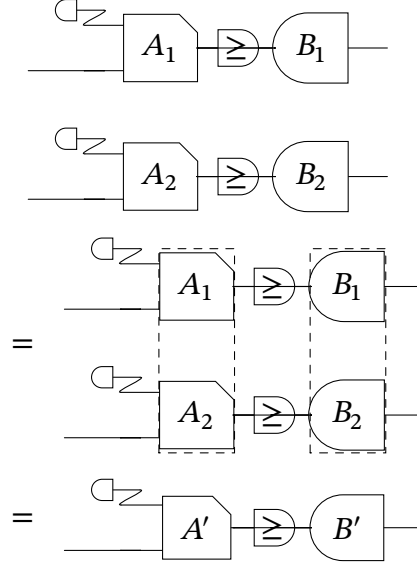
- The generator $\square -$



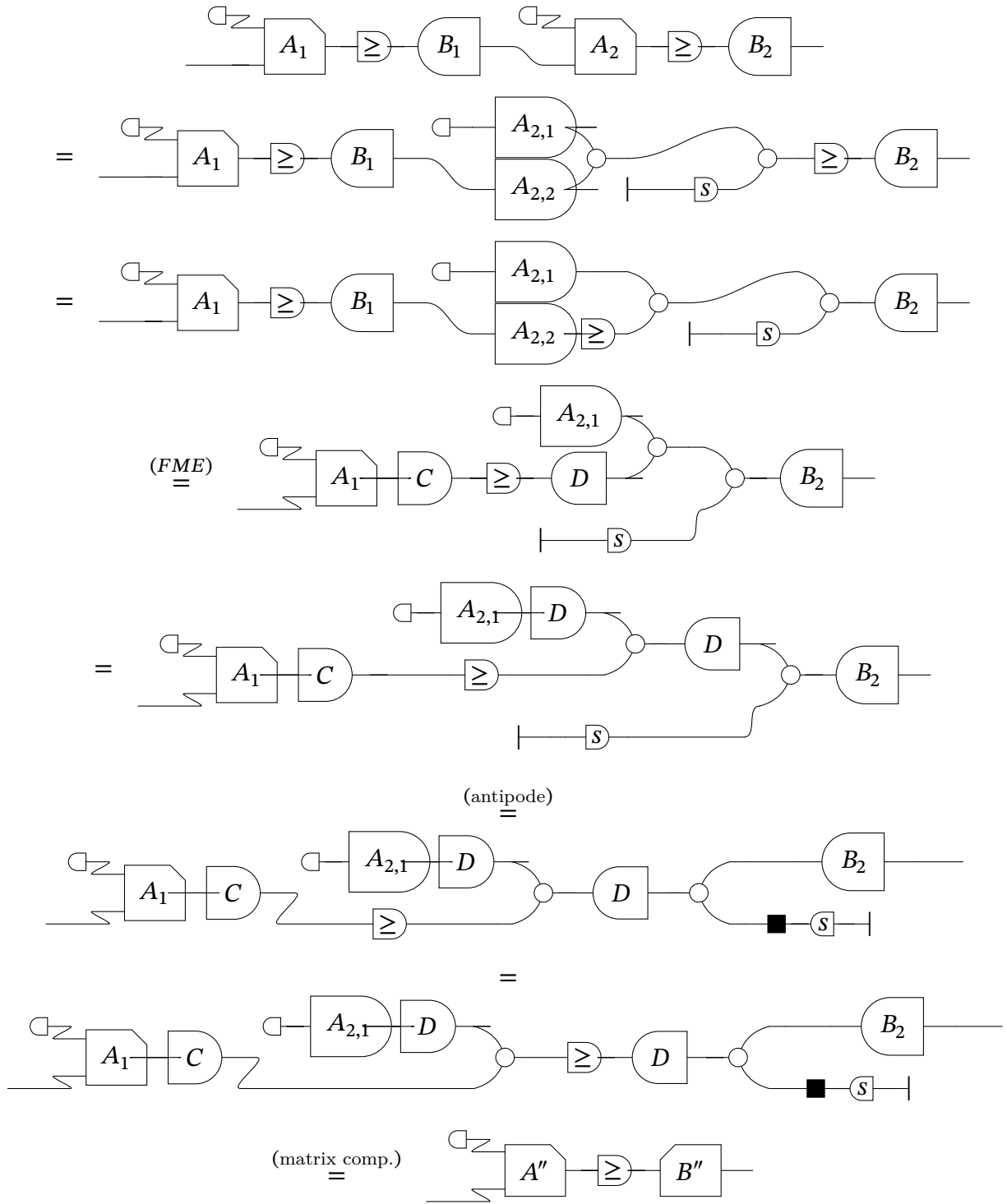
- A diagram $c \in \mathbf{GPA}$



For the inductive step, we verify that for any two diagrams $c, d \in \mathbf{GLP}$ satisfying the inductive hypothesis, both horizontal and vertical composition preserve the normal form. Closure under vertical composition follows by stacking the two normal forms and collapsing the two independent A_i, ge, B_i blocks into a single block-diagonal matrix pair, as shown below:



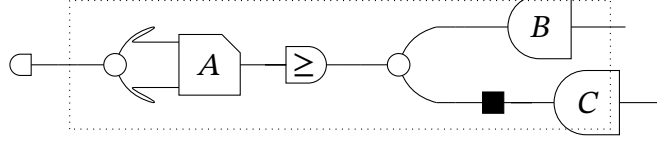
For horizontal composition, the two normal forms are joined along the wire connecting B_1 to A_2 ; applying Fourier-Motzkin Elimination to this pair recovers a fresh matrix-ge-comatrix triple, after which the two resulting runs of matrices, one in each direction, compose into a single matrix and a single comatrix, recovering the normal form:



□

The following corollary reveals the geometric meaning of the normal form: the **GPA** part of every **GLP** diagram encodes the epigraph of the corresponding value function. This is the key structural insight connecting the syntax to the semantic equivalence of Proposition 2.3.

Corollary 2.1 (Epigraph Form). *Given a diagram $d \in \mathbf{GLP}$ in normal form, it can always be rewritten as a diagram d' of the form:*



where the semantics of the dotted diagram is

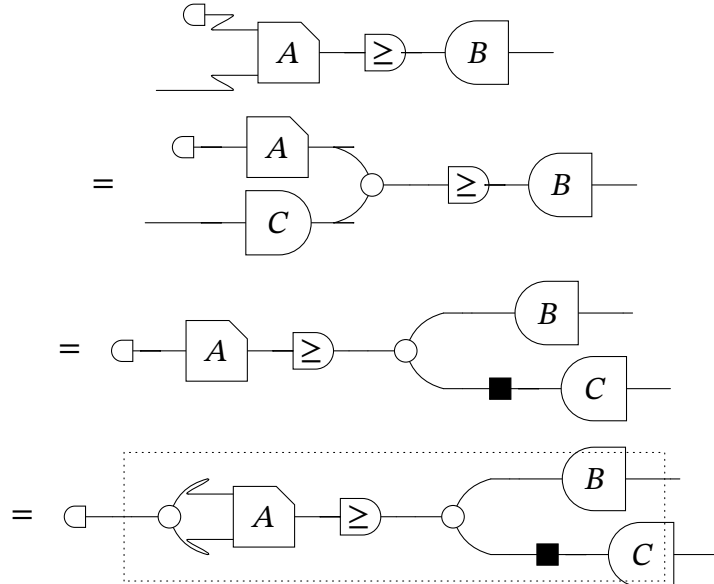
$$\left\{ (t, y) \mid \exists x, A'x + a \geq [B - C]y, t \geq x, y = \begin{bmatrix} y_1 \\ y_2 \end{bmatrix} \right\}$$

. This is the epigraph of the original diagram d

$$\begin{aligned} [d](y_1, y_2) &= \inf_z z \quad s.t. \quad Az + a \geq By_1 - Cy_2 \\ \text{epi}([d]) &= \{(t, y_1, y_2) \mid \exists z \leq t, Az + a \geq By_1 - Cy_2\} \end{aligned}$$

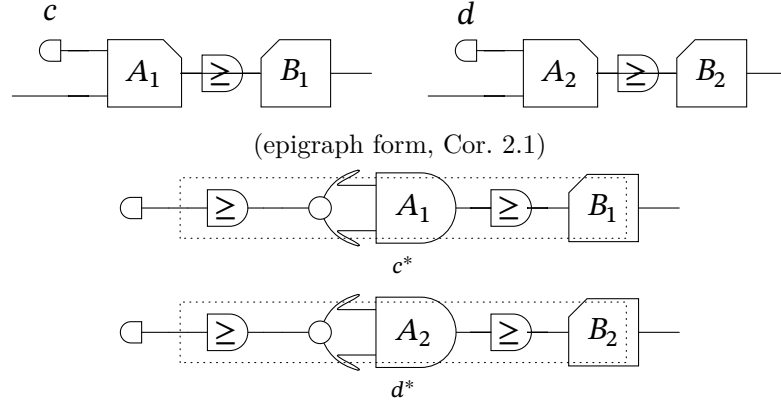
such that $A = [A' \ C]$. We call this the epigraph form of a linear program.

Proof. Starting from d in normal form, split the relation generator along $A = [A' \ C]$ and pull the resulting C -block through the $\geq$ generator using the antipode axiom:

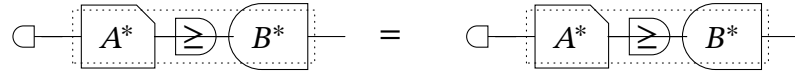


The resulting diagram is precisely the claimed form d' , with the dotted box exhibiting $\text{epi}([d])$ as a **GPA** diagram. $\square$

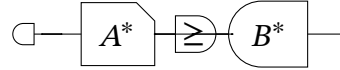
to the same **GPA** normal form. Composing this common diagram with the leftover $\sqsubset -$ collapses c and d to the same **GLP** diagram:



(the dotted boxes c^*, d^* are **GPA** diagrams with $[c^*] = [d^*] = E$; by **GPA** completeness both reduce to the same normal form)



(composing the common **GPA** normal form with the leftover $\sqsubset -$ yields the same **GLP** diagram)



Therefore $c = \sqsubset -$; $c^* = \sqsubset -$; $d^* = d$. □

As a consequence of the three lemmas above:

Theorem 2.2. ***LPRel** is presented by $\text{FreeP}_{\mathbf{GLP}}$.*

Proof. By the preceding three lemmas. □

Finally, we've built, through the addition of one generator and three axioms, an elegant and complete diagrammatic theory for parametric linear programming. This result does more than unlock a new algebraic and computational way to interact with LP problems: it relocates linear programming itself. A linear program is ordinarily presented as a function to be evaluated, an $x \mapsto c^T x$ subject to constraints, solved from the outside by an algorithm. Here it is instead a morphism, an object with an interface that composes with others of its kind, and solving it, evaluating it, and eliminating one of its variables are all the same operation, composition in **LPRel**. Optimization stops being a technique applied to a relational structure and becomes a property internal to it, and linear programming, in particular, is lifted out of the setting of functional thinking and given a new home as a relational field embedded in the Extended-Lawvere Quantale category.

The **GLP** theory, in turn, has a natural extension to an even more expressive theory when enriched with the gray arrow generator from **GQA** [Ste+24]. We believe that the

class of quadratic programs could be, just as was done in this work, fully axiomatized by such broader SMIT. However, such studies are left for future works, along with other possible applications of current results.

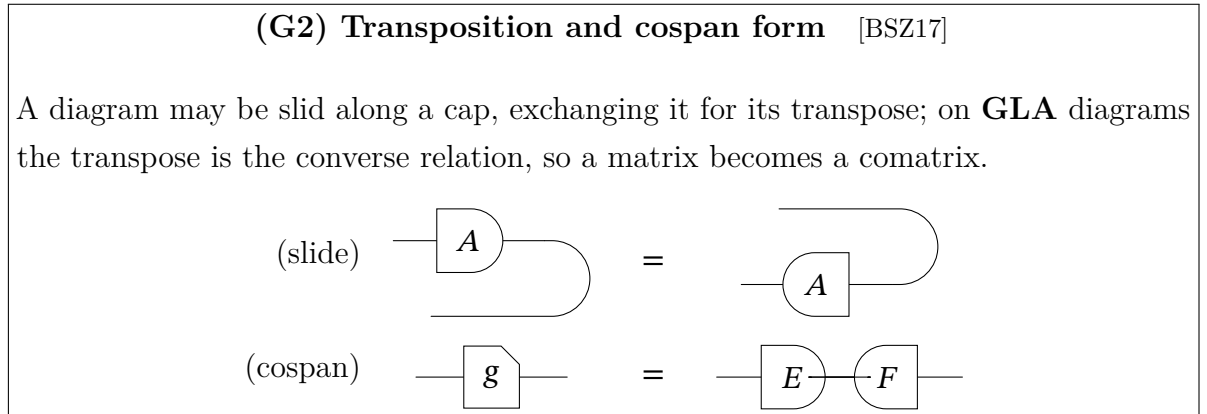
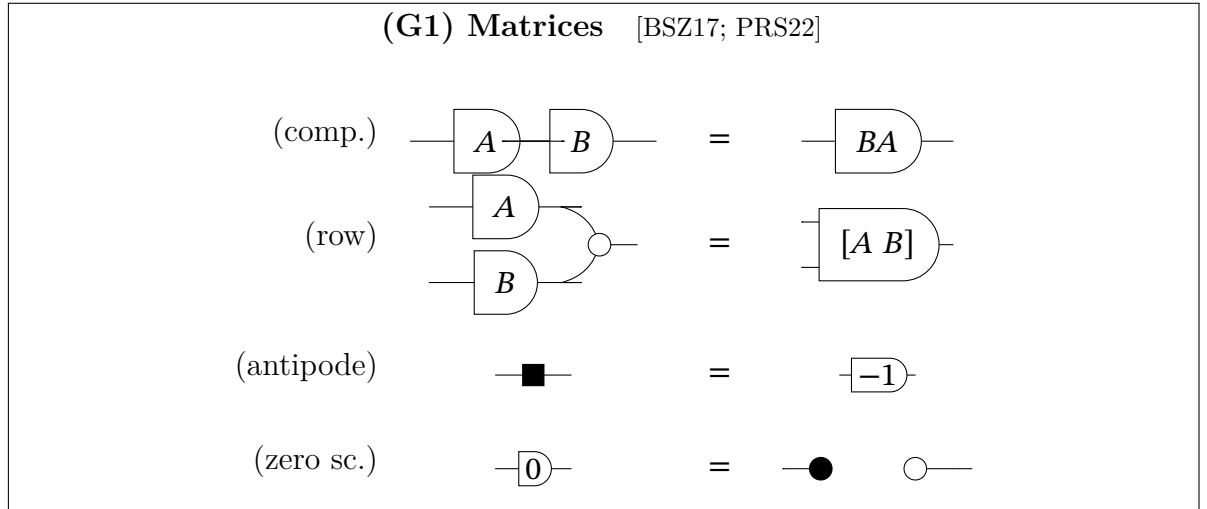
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A RULES OF THE UNDERLYING ALGEBRAS

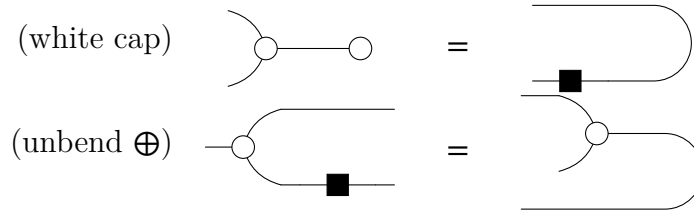
The derivations of Chapter 1 and Chapter 2 rest on a body of rules that belong to the linear and affine theories **GLA** and **GAA** rather than to the inequality layer studied here. They are established in [BSZ17; Bon+19; PRS22] and are collected below for reference, grouped as they are cited in the text: (G1) matrices, (G2) transposition, (G3) bending and (G4) the spider property of the black structure.

Semantically the four groups say, respectively: that diagrams denoting linear maps compose as matrices, so any such diagram may be replaced by a single box; that reflecting a diagram left-to-right denotes the converse relation, and that every linear relation factors as a cospan $E; F^{\text{op}}$, i.e. as the solution set of a system $Ev = Fw$; that an output wire may be bent into an input wire and back, the white cap differing from the black one by an antipode; and that a connected network of black nodes is determined by its number of inputs and outputs alone.



(G3) Bending [BSZ17; Bon+19]

The white cap is the black cap with an antipode on one leg; this is what turns an equation into a pair of bendable wires.



(G4) The black structure is a spider [BSZ17]

Any connected network of black nodes with a inputs and b outputs equals the single node $\text{cc}_a; \text{cp}_b$; the two laws below are the cases used here.

